WEEKLY MARKETS SUMMARY

Week of October 19–23, 2026

Global Markets Analysis · Nomad Capital · October 2026

NASDAQ 100 — WEEKLY CHG.

−0.79%

29,188 → 28,958 pts | −2.9% on Thursday

GOLD (FUT.) — WEEKLY CHG.

−4.14%

$4,181 → $4,008 | largest drop in 4+ months

WTI (FUT.) — WEEKLY CHG.

+4.27%

$99.04 → $103.27 | Brent above $116

ARGENTINA EMBI — WEEKLY CHG.

+59 bps

648 → 707 bps* | touched 710 on Tuesday

The week showed a market that stopped punishing everyone equally: risk aversion returned, but it concentrated in AI-linked credit, in sovereign debt with fiscal doubts and in assets that depend on low rates. On Thursday the Nasdaq 100 fell 2.9%, its worst session since June, after Meta reported its first negative free cash flow in more than a decade and Tesla cut its capex by 20%, and on Friday the Dow lost 1.2% with oil at its highest since April: WTI rose 4.3% to $103.27 and Brent topped $116 on Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia and the risk of escalation with Iran after November 3. Gold had its largest weekly drop in more than four months (−4.1%) as expensive energy reinforces the bet on higher rates for longer, with a Fed expected to pause on Wednesday the 28th but hike in December. In Argentina, country risk touched 710 points and ended the week at 707 (+59 bps), the MSCI Merval replaced the S&P Merval and gained 2.2% in pesos, and the MEP dollar advanced 1.7% to $1,562.

1. Timeline of the Week

WEEKLY TIMELINE	
Mon 10/19	MSCI replaced the S&P Merval as the local benchmark. Wall Street rebounded after semiconductors' worst week since March (eight straight SOX declines): Nasdaq 100 +1.17%, S&P 500 +0.41% at 7,690.73 and Dow −0.07%; the 10-year Treasury traded at 5.14%. Korean chips fell again after DeepSeek's latest model. In France, cost-of-living riots hit bonds and stocks and Macron rejected his interior minister's resignation. Trump exempted Russian energy from sanctions and tariffs and Brent pulled back from five-month highs; China's Q3 GDP grew 4.5%. After Warsh's comments, the market scaled back October hike bets and looks to December. EMBI: 675 bps.
Tue 10/20	Brent topped $110: Houthis hit energy sites and airports in Saudi Arabia and at least 18 vessels were struck in Hormuz in two weeks. Weak US housing data: starts 1.221M (est. 1.300M, −5.2% m/m) and pending home sales −7.3% m/m (est. −0.5%). France recorded almost 2,400 arrests and the 10-year yield neared 5%. S&P 500 +0.28% at 7,712.57, Dow +1.02% at 52,495.88 and Nasdaq 100 −0.13%. In Argentina, country risk touched 710 points intraday —the year's high— and closed at 672 bps after the announcement of US$20 billion of US backing; the September trade surplus came in at US$2.976 billion (est. US$2.5 billion).
Wed 10/21	The best session of the week: S&P 500 +0.58% at 7,757.17, Nasdaq 100 +1.13% and Dow +0.69% at 52,856.09, with the VIX at 16.68. The 20-year Treasury auction yielded 5.469%, the highest for that maturity since 1986. UK CPI reached 3.5% (an 11-month high) and the market prices a BoE hike on 11/5. Crude inventories −3.1M barrels (est. −0.8M). Argentina: the ruling bloc sent the borrowing bill back to committee for lack of votes, August activity fell 1.7% y/y (est. +0.3%) and the Treasury swapped 73% of the D30O6. EMBI: 674 bps. Meta and Tesla reported after the close.
Thu 10/22	Tech sell-off: the Nasdaq Composite lost 2.6% (Nasdaq 100 −2.90%), its worst day since June, after Meta's first negative free cash flow in over a decade, with a new share class to fund its spending, and Tesla's 20% cut to annual capex. S&P 500 −1.21% at 7,663.43; VIX +14% to 19.03. The 10-year fell almost 20 bps to 4.95% on safe-haven demand and gold lost 2.2% to $4,060. Jobless claims: 194K (est. 200K). Hang Seng −3.9% and the CSI 300 entered a bear market; France's 10-year yield topped 5% for the first time in 24 years. In Argentina, the EMBI jumped 30 bps to 704 and local stocks fell up to 6% on Wall Street; the CCL reached $1,638.
Fri 10/23	Dow −1.23% at 52,215.16, S&P 500 −0.47% at 7,623.68 and Nasdaq 100 flat (28,957.53), with the SOX +0.6%. Energy +2.4% to a record for the sector; AT&T and T-Mobile fell about 6% after a report that SpaceX is seeking cell sites for a fourth carrier, and American Express lost 3.9% despite raising its guidance. WTI closed at $103.27 and Brent topped $116, with reports that the US and Israel are weighing new strikes on Iran after 11/3. October Michigan sentiment: 48.0 (est. 46.3), with 1-year inflation expectations at 4.7%; S&P Global composite PMI: 57.6. Gold fell 1.3% to $4,007.90. In Argentina, the MSCI Merval rose 4.4% to 102,277.62 and ADRs rebounded up to 6%, but country risk closed at 707 bps, a step from the year's high.

2. Weekly Asset Price Changes

Prior close: Friday 10/16. Reference close: Friday 10/23.

Asset	Close Fri 10/16	Close Fri 10/23	Weekly chg.
S&P 500	7,659.44	7,623.68	−0.47%
Nasdaq 100	29,187.55	28,957.53	−0.79%
Dow Jones	52,002.41	52,215.16	+0.41%
VIX	19.99	19.45	−2.70%
UST 10Y	5.10%	4.99%	−11 bps
WTI (fut.)	$99.04	$103.27	+4.27%
Gold (fut.)	$4,181.10	$4,007.90	−4.14%
Bitcoin	$81,500.04	$81,078.04	−0.52%
EMBI Global (Argentina)	648 bps	707 bps*	+59 bps

Argentina local market	Close Fri 10/16	Close Fri 10/23	Weekly chg.
GD30D	$0.5688	$0.5647	−0.72%
GD35D	$0.7418	$0.7388	−0.40%
MSCI Merval (pesos)	100,076.00**	102,277.62	+2.20%
MSCI Merval (USD MEP)	65.12	65.47	+0.54%
USD MEP (AL30)	$1,536.73	$1,562.27	+1.66%

** Argentina EMBI: 707 bps per JP Morgan (as reported by Infobae); 648 bps is the official close of 10/16. ** Since 10/19 MSCI replaced the S&P Merval: the 10/16 value is the implied base (102,277.62 / 1.022) from the 2.2% weekly gain reported by the press, and is not comparable with prior weeks' S&P Merval levels. GD30D, GD35D, AL30 and AL30D verified on Balanz Productores at the 10/23 close; USD MEP = AL30 / AL30D. WTI refers to the December contract and the 10/16 close is the one reported last week; gold and Bitcoin are recomputed from the same source for both dates.*

3. Key Drivers of the Week

KEY DRIVERS	
AI credit takes control: Meta, Tesla and capex doubts give the Nasdaq 100 its worst day since June	On Thursday the Nasdaq 100 lost 2.9% after Meta showed its first negative free cash flow in more than a decade and issued a new share class to fund its investment, while Tesla cut annual capex by 20%; global hedge funds reportedly posted their worst day since the COVID crisis. The worry shifted from enthusiasm to financing: CoreWeave's 2031 bond is down more than 20% since April and trades below 80 cents, companies postponed more than US$5 billion of issuance and Citi expects caution in IPOs. Semiconductors rebounded on Monday and Friday after their worst streak since 2008, but credit-risk gauges for several tech names sit at highs. About one third of the S&P 500 reports next week, including Alphabet, Microsoft and Amazon, and capex guidance will be the focus; Q3 earnings are growing more than 32% according to LSEG, leaving little room for disappointment.
Oil at highs since April: Hormuz, Saudi Arabia and Iran concentrate the risk premium	WTI rose 4.3% on the week to $103.27 and Brent topped $116, driven by Houthi attacks on Saudi energy sites and airports, at least 18 vessels struck in Hormuz in two weeks and reports that the US and Israel are preparing new strikes on Iran after the 11/3 elections. Hormuz shipments exceed pre-war levels, but with freight rates more than 12 times higher and insurance near 10% of cargo: the market is paying an escalation premium, not for physical scarcity. The S&P 500 energy sector gained 2.4% on Friday to a record, European gas (TTF) touched EUR 93/MWh, a high since 2022, and US consumer sentiment stood at 48.0, near its record low, with 1-year inflation expectations at 4.7%.
Higher for longer: long bonds under pressure, France at the center and gold falls 4.1%	The 10-year Treasury ended the week at 4.99% after ranging between 5.15% and 4.95%, but the Treasury had to pay 5.469% to place 20-year bonds (the highest yield for that maturity since 1986): the safe haven works in panic sessions, yet the market charges more at the long end. 94% of economists polled by Reuters expect the Fed to hold on 10/28 and all expect a December hike; CPI rose to 3.5% in the UK and 3.8% in the eurozone, with the BoE (11/5) and the ECB on the radar. Gold, trading below its long-term average since late August, lost 4.1% to $4,008. In France, the 10-year yield topped 5% for the first time in 24 years, with a spread of about 157–165 bps over the Bund and a downgrade risk: the market is starting to price each sovereign borrower separately.
Argentina: country risk at the year's high despite US backing, with the Merval changing index	The EMBI went from 648 to 707 bps (+59 bps) and touched 710 on Tuesday, its high of the year, even with the announced US$20 billion US backstop, 17 straight sessions of BCRA purchases (US$1.103 billion in October through 10/20) and gross reserves above US$50.2 billion. The external backdrop weighs, along with a difficult local front: the ruling bloc sent the borrowing bill back to committee, the suspension of the PASO primaries is stuck in the Senate, August activity fell 1.7% y/y and operators are calling for a program "reset." Dollar bonds slipped (GD30D −0.72%, GD35D −0.40%), the MEP rose 1.7% to $1,562 and the CCL reached $1,653, a gap near 6%. The MSCI Merval, which replaced the S&P Merval on 10/19, gained 2.2% in pesos and 4.4% on Friday, though it was roughly flat in dollars.

4. Signals to Watch — Week of October 26–30

SIGNALS TO WATCH	
Brazil: runoff on Sunday 10/25 between Flávio Bolsonaro and Lula	The polling model and Polymarket give Flávio about a 77% chance, although Datafolha showed a tie in valid votes. Options on the Brazil ETF price a 7% rise if Flávio wins and a 24% drop if Lula wins. More than the winner, what matters is whether on Monday the real, the rates curve and equities move in the same direction and which economic team is announced; the January 2028 rate stands at 12.88%.
Fed on 10/28, ECB and Big Tech earnings week	A Fed pause is expected on Wednesday the 28th with focus on the signal for December (12/8–9 meeting); the ECB Council also meets with France as the backdrop. Alphabet, Microsoft and Amazon report (Amazon plans about US$220 billion of capex in 2026): watch AI investment guidance, tech-issuer CDS, CoreWeave's bonds and high-yield spreads.
Oil and Iran ahead of the ballots: Israel (10/27) and the US (11/3)	With Brent above $116 and WTI above $100, watch new Houthi attacks on Saudi Arabia, tanker rates and European gas inventories (near 75%). Israel's election on Tuesday 10/27 conditions the escalation Washington and Jerusalem would weigh after 11/3; an attack on production capacity, and not just facilities, would take the barrel to another level.
Sovereign debt in Europe and the US: France, the Treasury plan on 11/4 and the BoE on 11/5	If France's 10-year yield holds above 5% and the spread against the Bund keeps widening, the eurozone fragmentation debate reopens. In the US, the 11/4 issuance plan will define whether the Treasury cuts long-bond supply; rising long yields on a day when stocks fall would break the safe-haven thesis.
Argentina: the 700 bps level, BCRA purchases, the gap and 2027 financing	Watch whether country risk consolidates 700 bps as a ceiling, the pace of BCRA purchases, the CCL gap (10% threshold), month-end maturities and the handling of the borrowing bill and electoral reform, which should be settled before mid-November. On the horizon: the YPF ruling (deadline 12/2) and JD Vance's visit in November.

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